QQ-G-547B
July 14, 1975
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. QQ-G-00547a(GSA-FSS)
November 30, 1967 and
Fed. Spec. QQ-G-547
November 8, 1960

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

GOLD LEAF

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a gold leaf in the form of sheets furnished in books.

1.2 CLASSIFICATION

1.2.1 Grade. Gold leaf shall be furnished in one grade (95.5 percent).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes, Paperboard, Edge and Components.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-Up,
PPP-T-97 - Tape; Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Filament Reinforced.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 224 - Closing, Sealing and Reinforcing of Fiberboard Shipping Boxes, General Methods for.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, Waterproof.

Military Standard:

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

FSC 8010

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(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Gold leaf 3-3/8 x 3-3/8 inches shall contain not less than 0.2125 ounces (troy) of gold alloy in each pack of 20 books.

3.1.1 Gold alloy shall show an analysis not less than 95.5 percent pure gold (see 6.2).

3.2 Gold leaf shall be furnished in the form of sheets free from creases and folds.

3.2.1 Each leaf shall be 3-3/8 inch square.

3.3 Construction. Gold leaf shall be furnished in books with each leaf loosely placed between leaves of books or with gold leaf pressed on white tissue paper (to make handling in wind or air currents easier), as specified (see 6.3). Each tissue with gold leaf adhered loosely shall be placed between leaves of the book. (This latter is known in the trade as patent gold leaf.)

3.3.1 Each book of gold leaf shall contain 25 sheets of gold leaf.

3.3.2 Each book shall be bound with a suitable cover.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling and testing. A single book shall be selected at random as the sample under inspection. This book shall be properly marked and packed to prevent damage due to creasing or bending in transit and forwarded to the laboratory at which analysis is to be made (see 6.4). All books of gold leaf offered for delivery at one time shall be considered a lot for purposes of sampling and inspection.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 Examine each sheet in the book for creases and folds.

4.3.2 Weight. Select 10 sheets from the book, weigh to nearest 0.1 milligram and calculate the amount of gold alloy, in troy ounces, in a pack of 20 books, using the factor, 1 troy ounce = 31.1 grams.

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4.3.3 Chemical analysis. From the 10 sheets selected for tests prescribed by paragraph 4.2, weigh out not less than 100 milligrams for chemical analysis. This may be made by either the standard fire assay method or some other procedure of equivalent precision [1] (see 6.4).

4.3.4 Action as results of inspection. If any leaf is damaged, if the full count of 25 is not found, if the weight of 10 leaves is less than specified, or if the purity is less than specified, the entire lot shall be rejected.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Gold leaf shall be packaged level A or C, as specified in the contract or order (see 6.3).

5.1.1 Level A. Twenty books shall be packaged in paperboard folding or set-up boxes conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676. Box closure shall be as specified in the applicable box specification or appendix.

5.1.2 Level C. Books shall be packaged in accordance with manufacturer's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Gold leaf shall be packed level A, B or C as specified in the contract or order (see 6.3).

5.2.1 Level A. Gold leaf shall be packed in fiberboard boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, V3c. Gross weight of boxes shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification. Box closures shall conform to the appendix of PPP-B-636. In lieu of steel strapping, boxes may be reinforced with pressure-sensitive filament tape conforming to type IV of Federal Specification PPP-T-97, applied in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 224. Boxes shall be provided with caseliners conforming to MIL-L-10547. Caseliners shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the appendix to MIL-L-10547. Caseliners may be omitted provided all center and edge seams and manufacturers joints are sealed with minimum 1-1/2-inch-wide tape conforming to PPP-T-97.

5.2.2 Level B. Gold leaf shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except that six unit packages, packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in boxes conforming to class domestic of PPP-B-636. Caseliners shall not be required.

5.2.3 Level C. Gold leaf, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination. Containers shall comply with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Military activities. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.2 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.

6.1.1 Use. Gold leaf is used extensively on statues, memorials and buildings, from complete coverage of domes to such small highlight spots as flagpole balls, and in the interior for all kinds of decoration to complete ceilings. Both inside and out, gold leaf is used for all types of lettering and identification signs. Any surface which can be painted can be gilded.

1/ Such methods are described in detail in any standard text book such as Fulton's Manual of Fire Assaying or Standard Methods of Chemical Analysis, Scott, Fourth Edition, Vol. 1.

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6.1.2 Application. On surface applications wherever practical, it is advisable to use a slow drying oil gold size (yellow). This usually dries to the correct tack in from 12 to 18 hours, and holds its tack for 6 to 10 hours thereafter. Drying time of all sizes vary widely due to different atmospheric conditions.

Where the job is so small that it would be too costly to wait for slow size to set up, or where there is a good deal of dust or where the likelihood of inclement weather makes it inadvisable or impractical to use "slow" size, a synthetic quick drying gold size may be used instead. This usually dries to a tack in from 2 to 3 hours. The addition of a few drops of fat oil size will slow up drying according to amount used. Always remember, however, it is much easier to obtain a good burnish with a slow oil size, which is also more durable on exterior work.

Do not use a protective coating over Gold Leaf on exterior applications, 23Kt. Gold Leaf will far outlast any coating that may be applied to it. Such a coating also decreases lustre. Interior application of Gold Leaf should not be given a protective coating unless it is subjected to unusual abrasion or handling. Where a protective coating is necessary, use a synthetic quick drying gold size to apply the gold leaf.

6.2 Because of the usual presence of a small amount of rouge on each sheet of gold leaf, to facilitate handling, manufacturers are warned that to use a gold alloy of exactly 95.5 percent pure gold for making gold leaf may result in failure to meet the specification requirement for fineness (see 3.1.1).

6.3 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Form required (see 3.3).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing required. (See 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Special marking required (see 5.3).

6.4 Since few chemical laboratories are equipped to make gold assays, it is suggested that samples be sent to the United States Mint Service for the determination of the percentage of pure gold. The following branches of the Mint Service will assay gold leaf for a fee:

United States Mint, Denver, Colorado 80204
United States Mint, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19106
United States Mint, San Francisco, California 94102
United States Assay Office, New York, New York 10005
United States Assay Office, San Francisco, California 94102

6.5 Purchasers should specify the form in which gold leaf is required, as covered by paragraph 3.3.

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See Section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 25 cents each.

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